



AP[®] English Language and Composition Practice Exam

From the 2012 Administration

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ENGLISH LANGUAGE AND COMPOSITION

SECTION I

Time—1 hour

Directions: This part consists of selections from prose works and questions on their content, form, and style. After reading each passage, choose the best answer to each question and completely fill in the corresponding circle on the answer sheet.

Note: Pay particular attention to the requirement of questions that contain the words NOT, LEAST, or EXCEPT.

Questions 1-15. Read the following passage carefully before you choose your answers.

(This passage is excerpted from a publication by a contemporary biologist.)

We know less about life on earth than we know about the surface of the moon and Mars—in part because far less money has been spent studying it.

Line Taxonomy, the study of classification and hence of
5 biological diversity, has been allowed to dwindle, while other important fields such as space exploration and biomedical studies have flourished. Like glass-
blowing and harpsichord manufacture, taxonomy of
10 many kinds of organisms has been left in the hands of a small number of unappreciated specialists who have had few opportunities to train their successors. To
take one of hundreds of examples, two of the four
most abundant groups of small animals of the soil are
springtails and oribatid mites. Marvelously varied,
15 having complex life cycles, and teeming by the millions in every acre of land, these tiny animals play vital ecological roles by consuming dead vegetable
matter. Thus they help to drive the energy and
materials cycles on which all life depends. Yet there
20 are only four specialists in the United States who can identify springtails—one is retired—and only one is an expert on oribatid mites. The reason that so little
is heard about these important organisms in the
scientific literature and popular press is that there are
25 so few people who know enough to write about them at any level.

The general neglect of expertise in the face of
overwhelming need and opportunity rebounds to the
weakness of many other enterprises in science and
30 education. Museums are understaffed, with too few biologists to develop research collections and prepare exhibitions. Systematics, the branch of biology that
employs taxonomy and the study of similarities
among species to work out the evolution of groups of
35 organisms, is able to address only a minute fraction of life. Biogeography, the analysis of the distribution of organisms, is similarly hobbled. So is ecology, the
extremely important discipline that explores the

relationships of organisms to their environment and to
40 one another. A great deal of the future of biology depends on the strengthening of taxonomy, for if you can't tell one kind of plant or animal from another, you are in trouble. Some kinds of research may be
held up indefinitely. As the Chinese say, the
45 beginning of wisdom is getting things by their right names.

The study of classification and expertise on
"obscure" groups of organisms such as periwinkles,
leeches, springtails and mites may receive the needed
50 boost by association with what has come to be known as biodiversity studies. Biodiversity studies constitute a hybrid discipline that took solid form during the
1980s. They can be defined (a bit formally, I admit,
but bear with me) as follows: the systematic
55 examination of the full array of organisms and the origin of this diversity, together with the technology
by which diversity can be maintained and utilized for the benefit of humanity. Thus biodiversity studies are
both scientific in nature, a branch of pure evolutionary
60 biology, and applied studies, a branch of biotechnology.

Two events during the past quarter-century brought
biodiversity to center stage and encouraged the
deliberately hybrid form of its analysis. The first was
65 the recognition that human activity threatens the extinction of not only a few "star" species such as
giant pandas and California condors, but also a large
fraction of all the species of plants and animals on
earth. At least one-quarter of the species on earth are
70 likely to vanish due to the cutting and burning of tropical rainforests alone if the current rate of
destruction continues. The second reason for the new
prominence of biodiversity studies is the recognition
that extinction can be slowed and eventually halted
75 without significant cost to humanity. *Extinction is not a price we are compelled to pay for economic
progress.* Quite the contrary: As the examples of the
rosy periwinkle and medicinal leech suggest,
conservation can promote human welfare. Ultimately
80 conservation might even be necessary for continued
progress in many realms of human endeavor.

1. The primary purpose of the first paragraph (lines 1-26) is to
 - (A) inspire students to enter scientific professions
 - (B) argue that certain animal groups are becoming extinct
 - (C) encourage people to follow the progress of current scientific research
 - (D) call attention to the decline of a significant field of study
 - (E) explain the relationship between different scientific disciplines
2. The author mentions “glass-blowing and harpsichord manufacture” (lines 7-8) to suggest that taxonomy is
 - (A) a field characterized by antiquated practices
 - (B) an art that is extremely difficult to master
 - (C) a profession practiced by relatively few people
 - (D) an area of expertise with various practical applications
 - (E) a discipline that has limited usefulness
3. The series of phrases in lines 14-16 (“Marvelously varied . . . acre of land”) primarily conveys the
 - (A) critical job that springtails and oribatid mites perform in the natural environment
 - (B) ferocity with which springtails and oribatid mites compete for survival
 - (C) array of tiny animals that coexist with springtails and oribatid mites in the soil
 - (D) characteristics of springtails and oribatid mites
 - (E) life span of springtails and oribatid mites living in the soil
4. In the context of lines 19-22, the words “one is retired” are best described as
 - (A) a detail that makes a critical situation even more precarious
 - (B) a fact that is puzzling to the author and other biologists
 - (C) a claim that is of equal concern to scientists and the general public
 - (D) an excuse for outdated designs for research projects
 - (E) an aside that undermines the point about taxonomy that is being made
5. Which of the following best describes the relationship between the first and second paragraphs?
 - (A) The second paragraph illustrates the work of the specialists mentioned in the first paragraph.
 - (B) The second paragraph describes the effects of an issue raised in the first paragraph.
 - (C) The second paragraph questions the logic of an idea expressed in the first paragraph.
 - (D) The second paragraph considers factors that could remedy the situation discussed in the first paragraph.
 - (E) The second paragraph lists the practical applications of a theory proposed in the first paragraph.
6. The author cites a Chinese saying (lines 44-46) to emphasize the
 - (A) contrast between Eastern and Western science
 - (B) intricacy of the relationships that unite living beings
 - (C) necessity of using scientific knowledge in a responsible manner
 - (D) importance of taxonomy as a field of study
 - (E) danger of postponing biological research
7. The author uses the word “obscure” in line 48 to mean
 - (A) ambiguous
 - (B) incomprehensible
 - (C) not well known
 - (D) uncertain
 - (E) unusually small
8. The third paragraph (lines 47-61) serves which of the following functions?
 - (A) It explains the results of a controversial study.
 - (B) It compares examples that illustrate a point.
 - (C) It explores social and historical contexts.
 - (D) It speculates about a potential improvement.
 - (E) It presents an opposing point of view.

The passage is reprinted for your use in answering the remaining questions.

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Line
5 We know less about life on earth than we know about the surface of the moon and Mars—in part because far less money has been spent studying it. Taxonomy, the study of classification and hence of biological diversity, has been allowed to dwindle, while other important fields such as space exploration and biomedical studies have flourished. Like glass-blowing and harpsichord manufacture, taxonomy of many kinds of organisms has been left in the hands of a small number of unappreciated specialists who have had few opportunities to train their successors. To take one of hundreds of examples, two of the four most abundant groups of small animals of the soil are springtails and oribatid mites. Marvelously varied, having complex life cycles, and teeming by the millions in every acre of land, these tiny animals play vital ecological roles by consuming dead vegetable matter. Thus they help to drive the energy and materials cycles on which all life depends. Yet there are only four specialists in the United States who can identify springtails—one is retired—and only one is an expert on oribatid mites. The reason that so little is heard about these important organisms in the scientific literature and popular press is that there are so few people who know enough to write about them at any level.

30 The general neglect of expertise in the face of overwhelming need and opportunity rebounds to the weakness of many other enterprises in science and education. Museums are understaffed, with too few biologists to develop research collections and prepare exhibitions. Systematics, the branch of biology that employs taxonomy and the study of similarities among species to work out the evolution of groups of organisms, is able to address only a minute fraction of life. Biogeography, the analysis of the distribution of organisms, is similarly hobbled. So is ecology, the extremely important discipline that explores the

relationships of organisms to their environment and to one another. A great deal of the future of biology depends on the strengthening of taxonomy, for if you can't tell one kind of plant or animal from another, you are in trouble. Some kinds of research may be held up indefinitely. As the Chinese say, the beginning of wisdom is getting things by their right names.

40 The study of classification and expertise on “obscure” groups of organisms such as periwinkles, leeches, springtails and mites may receive the needed boost by association with what has come to be known as biodiversity studies. Biodiversity studies constitute a hybrid discipline that took solid form during the 1980s. They can be defined (a bit formally, I admit, but bear with me) as follows: the systematic examination of the full array of organisms and the origin of this diversity, together with the technology by which diversity can be maintained and utilized for the benefit of humanity. Thus biodiversity studies are both scientific in nature, a branch of pure evolutionary biology, and applied studies, a branch of biotechnology.

Two events during the past quarter-century brought biodiversity to center stage and encouraged the deliberately hybrid form of its analysis. The first was the recognition that human activity threatens the extinction of not only a few “star” species such as giant pandas and California condors, but also a large fraction of all the species of plants and animals on earth. At least one-quarter of the species on earth are likely to vanish due to the cutting and burning of tropical rainforests alone if the current rate of destruction continues. The second reason for the new prominence of biodiversity studies is the recognition that extinction can be slowed and eventually halted without significant cost to humanity. *Extinction is not a price we are compelled to pay for economic progress.* Quite the contrary: As the examples of the rosy periwinkle and medicinal leech suggest, conservation can promote human welfare. Ultimately conservation might even be necessary for continued progress in many realms of human endeavor.

9. Which of the following is true of the position presented in lines 72-77 (“The second . . . progress”) ?
- (A) It is based on information provided at the beginning of the passage.
 - (B) It takes issue with the claims made in the previous sentence.
 - (C) It acknowledges that the solution to the problem will involve painful choices.
 - (D) It emphasizes that immediate action is essential for success.
 - (E) It suggests that an assumption held by many people may be incorrect.
10. One important purpose of the passage is to
- (A) urge the public to contribute money to a proposed taxonomy project
 - (B) argue that the public should focus on identifying and saving a few key species
 - (C) suggest that ecological conservation is a beneficial enterprise
 - (D) question why some species are better protected than others
 - (E) promote specific organizations devoted to improving global well-being
11. The primary rhetorical strategy in the passage is the
- (A) exemplification of key concepts and ideas
 - (B) narration of stories and use of personal references
 - (C) description of research methodologies
 - (D) comparison and contrast of differing viewpoints
 - (E) reevaluation of traditional notions of cause and effect
12. In the passage, italics are used to highlight
- (A) citations from different authorities
 - (B) ideas that scientists consider outdated
 - (C) the hypotheses that the author challenges
 - (D) trends that the author has encouraged
 - (E) the major points of the author’s argument
13. The author’s tone is best described as
- (A) polite yet condescending
 - (B) concerned yet hopeful
 - (C) critical and indignant
 - (D) eager and amazed
 - (E) pessimistic and discouraged
14. The passage is most likely excerpted from
- (A) an educational article promoting awareness of a critical scientific issue
 - (B) a scholarly essay substantiating the veracity of a recent scientific discovery
 - (C) a historical document describing public funding for biodiversity studies
 - (D) a research report criticizing the behavior of both sides in a current scientific debate
 - (E) an informational pamphlet discussing exhibits in a natural history museum
15. It can be inferred from the passage that the author assumes the reader is
- (A) an expert questioning every aspect of the author’s argument
 - (B) a generalist who needs an explanation of specialized concepts
 - (C) a student seeking facts in order to develop a testable thesis
 - (D) a colleague evaluating a proposal for a research project
 - (E) an enthusiast aware of current discoveries and debates

Questions 16-28. Read the following passage carefully before you choose your answers.

(This passage is taken from a book that examines Canadian book clubs.)

Line So pronounced is the book-club phenomenon
that the format has spread to other venues and media,
the most famous of these being the ‘book club’
5 component of Oprah Winfrey’s television talk show.
Staged like an actual book-group meeting, with
invited discussants and a cozy living-room setting,
the Winfrey show can boost a featured title to instant
bestsellerdom and turn authors into stars. There
are now ‘book clubs’ online, in bookstores, and
10 functioning as consumer focus groups for publishers.¹
Colleges, bookstores, and resorts have recently
begun to develop ‘readers’ retreats.’² Newsletters,
magazines, newspapers, and published guides advise
readers how to find, establish, and manage successful
15 clubs.³

The widespread popularity of these reading groups
has even occasioned a form of ‘book-club backlash.’
In a newspaper opinion piece titled ‘Why I Won’t
Join the Book Club,’ one contributor expressed alarm
20 that reading was becoming another scheduled activity
to be slotted in ‘like the trip to the gym and the
grocery store’; self-improving readers ‘pop’ books as
they would vitamin tablets. But books ‘are not about
schedules,’ author Stephanie Nolen argues; rather,
25 they are ‘about submerging yourself . . . about getting
lost, about getting consumed.’⁴ Considerable attention
was garnered by another article, detailing the darker
side of some New York City reading groups.
Headlined ‘Book-Club Lovers Wage a War of Words’
30 when reprinted by the *Globe and Mail*, it could
equally well have been titled ‘When Book Clubs Go
Bad’: ‘No longer just friendly social gatherings with
a vague continuing-education agenda, many of
today’s book groups have become literary pressure
35 cookers, marked by aggressive intellectual one-
upmanship and unabashed social skirmishing. In
living rooms and bookshops, clubs are frazzling under
the stress, giving rise to a whole new profession: the
book-group therapist.’⁵ The clubs that Elaine Daspin
40 describes here seem to be functioning as
unconsciousness- rather than consciousness-raising
sessions, where competitive readers battle for
interpretive supremacy. While book-club therapists
may well be confined to the rarefied worlds of the
45 Upper East Side or Long Island, authors of recent
book-club guides reiterate the need to establish
common purposes, regular routines, and guidelines
for thorough preparation.

Clearly, the positives outweigh the pitfalls; book
50 clubs are in demand because they offer individual
readers an extra dimension of appreciation and
understanding. Yet despite the fact that shared
discussion of literary texts is also the foundation
of literary study in school, college, and university
55 classrooms, literary theorists and reader-response
critics have yet to devote much attention to such
shared and synergistic study, instead construing
readers as isolates or abstractions. (Studies tend
to focus on the emotional responses or cognitive
60 activities of individual readers, or to infer such
reactions by examining the properties of a literary
text.) But club and classroom participants know that
there is something different, something added, about
sharing and discussing literature with other people.

¹ For an example of an online ‘book club’—this one produced by a mass-market circulation women’s magazine—see *Conversations (Book Club)* on Chateleine Connects at www.canoe.ca/chateleine.

² For example, Vancouver bookseller Celia Duthie is developing such ‘retreats’ at a country inn. There are discussion periods and visits by authors and, most importantly, time to read. See Keyes, ‘Out of the Woods.’

³ Some popular guides are Greenwood et al., *The Go on Girl!*; Jacobson, *The Reading Group Handbook*; and Saal, *The New York Public Library Guide to Reading Groups*. A new entry to the field, developed with a particular eye to the needs of Canadian clubs, is Heft and O’Brien, *Build a Better Book Club*.

⁴ Nolen, ‘Why I Won’t Join the Book Club’

⁵ Daspin, ‘Book-Club Lovers Wage a War of Words.’ The piece originally appeared in the *Wall Street Journal*.

16. The organization of the passage can best be described as
- (A) personal narrative followed by analysis
 - (B) empirical data followed by conjecture
 - (C) nonjudgmental explanation of a current phenomenon followed by a question
 - (D) descriptive analysis followed by a final judgment
 - (E) condemnation of a practice followed by partial acceptance
17. In context, the author places the term “book club” in quotation marks in lines 3 and 9 in order to
- (A) show that these are humorous examples
 - (B) highlight how formal some of these clubs are
 - (C) reveal that the book clubs that appear online or on television are unsatisfactory
 - (D) suggest that the term is being broadened beyond its original meaning
 - (E) imply that many book club members do not like the term
18. The first paragraph (lines 1-15) serves to
- (A) explain why the author enjoys one way of reading
 - (B) describe the extension of a particular activity into nontraditional areas
 - (C) make generalizations that will be developed later
 - (D) explore ways in which people can structure free time
 - (E) detail the power of media and mass marketing to censor
19. According to lines 23-26, Stephanie Nolen’s primary criticism of book clubs is that they
- (A) are too programmed
 - (B) do not offer enough variety
 - (C) cause readers to be anxious
 - (D) overlook many classics
 - (E) forego quality for quantity
20. The clubs referred to in line 39 are discussed in
- (A) the online discussion group of a particular book club
 - (B) a study sponsored by book club participants
 - (C) an editorial in a Canadian magazine
 - (D) a guide written by Elaine Daspin
 - (E) an article published in the *Wall Street Journal*
21. The “recent book-club guides” (lines 45-46) tend to emphasize
- (A) how book clubs need to be structured and regular in order to succeed
 - (B) how difficult it is to start a book club in New York
 - (C) how often even the best book clubs fail
 - (D) the variety of reasons that people have for starting book clubs
 - (E) the challenges of selecting books for discussion
22. The last paragraph (lines 49-64) marks a shift from
- (A) popular to academic contexts
 - (B) supported to unsound generalizations
 - (C) impersonal to personal examples
 - (D) subtle irony to explicit sarcasm
 - (E) neutral to negative characterization of book clubs
23. The function of lines 52-58 (“Yet despite . . . abstractions”) is to
- (A) argue for the value of a particular literary theory
 - (B) explain how important it is not to make abstract judgments
 - (C) point out a discrepancy between teaching practices and literary theory
 - (D) highlight the demand for a way to measure emotional responses to texts
 - (E) explore the author’s views about reading in isolation
24. The final sentence (lines 62-64) serves to
- (A) conclude an argument begun in the first paragraph
 - (B) suggest a probable cause for an ongoing phenomenon
 - (C) argue that publishers need to pay more attention to book clubs
 - (D) offer a final analysis of the phenomenon described in the second paragraph
 - (E) explain why the author has chosen a particular field of study

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the most famous of these being the ‘book club’
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10 functioning as consumer focus groups for publishers.¹
Colleges, bookstores, and resorts have recently
begun to develop ‘readers’ retreats.’² Newsletters,
magazines, newspapers, and published guides advise
readers how to find, establish, and manage successful
15 clubs.³

The widespread popularity of these reading groups
has even occasioned a form of ‘book-club backlash.’
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Join the Book Club,’ one contributor expressed alarm
20 that reading was becoming another scheduled activity
to be slotted in ‘like the trip to the gym and the
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schedules,’ author Stephanie Nolen argues; rather,
25 they are ‘about submerging yourself . . . about getting
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was garnered by another article, detailing the darker
side of some New York City reading groups.
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the stress, giving rise to a whole new profession: the
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25. One function of sentence 3 (lines 8-10) and endnote 1 is to
- (A) give an example of a group that earns money by reading
 - (B) show that book clubs are not intended for literary scholars
 - (C) note the connection between marketing and book clubs
 - (D) cite one book club as a particular model of excellence
 - (E) suggest the benefits of online discussion groups
26. It can be inferred from endnote 2 that “ ‘Out of the Woods’ ” is
- (A) an article about a type of retreat
 - (B) an exposé about fee-based book clubs
 - (C) an essay about book club protocol
 - (D) a meditation on favorite works by famous authors
 - (E) an article about how to start a traditional book club
27. The function of endnote 3 is to
- (A) offer specific examples of one of the types of resources mentioned
 - (B) convince the reader of the value of book clubs
 - (C) test whether the reader is interested in particular books
 - (D) evaluate tips on how to set up book clubs
 - (E) compare the strengths and weaknesses of certain books
28. The information in endnote 2 is different from that in endnote 3 in that endnote 2
- (A) is critical while endnote 3 is neutral
 - (B) assumes that readers do not like research while endnote 3 assumes that readers like research
 - (C) is concerned with local book clubs while endnote 3 relates to global issues
 - (D) primarily provides an illustration of a phenomenon while endnote 3 primarily lists resources
 - (E) relates mostly to marketing while endnote 3 relates mostly to cultural conflicts in book clubs

Questions 29-41. Read the following passage carefully before you choose your answers.

(This passage is from a contemporary essay.)

Line Landscape thus has similarities with dreams. Both
have the power to seize terrifying feelings and deep
instincts and translate them into images—visual,
aural, tactile—into the concrete where human beings
5 may more readily confront and channel the terrifying
instincts or powerful emotions into rituals and narra-
tives which reassure the individual while reaffirming
cherished values of the group. The identity of the
individual as a part of the group and the greater
10 Whole is strengthened, and the terror of facing the
world alone is extinguished.

Even now, the people at Laguna Pueblo spend
the greater portion of social occasions recounting
recent incidents or events which have occurred in
15 the Laguna area. Nearly always, the discussion will
precipitate the retelling of older stories about similar
incidents or other stories connected with a specific
place. The stories often contain disturbing or provoc-
ative material, but are nonetheless told in the presence
20 of children and women. The effect of these inter-
family or inter-clan exchanges is the reassurance for
each person that she or he will never be separated or
apart from the clan, no matter what might happen.
Neither the worst blunders or disasters nor the
25 greatest financial prosperity and joy will ever be
permitted to isolate anyone from the rest of the group.
In the ancient times, cohesiveness was all that stood
between extinction and survival, and, while the indi-
vidual certainly was recognized, it was always as an
30 individual simultaneously bonded to family and clan
by a complex bundle of custom and ritual. You are
never the first to suffer a grave loss or profound
humiliation. You are never the first, and you under-
stand that you will probably not be the last to commit
35 or be victimized by a repugnant act. Your family and
clan are able to go on at length about others now
passed on, others older or more experienced than
you who suffered similar losses.

The wide deep arroyo near the Kings Bar (located
40 across the reservation borderline) has over the years
claimed many vehicles. A few years ago, when a
Vietnam veteran's new red Volkswagen rolled back-
wards into the arroyo while he was inside buying a
six-pack of beer, the story of his loss joined the lively
45 and large collection of stories already connected with
that big arroyo. I do not know whether the Vietnam
veteran was consoled when he was told the stories
about the other cars claimed by the ravenous arroyo.
All his savings of combat pay had gone for the red

50 Volkswagen. But this man could not have felt any
worse than the man who, some years before, had left
his children and mother-in-law in his station wagon
with the engine running. When he came out of the
liquor store his station wagon was gone. He found
55 it and its passengers upside down in the big arroyo.
Broken bones, cuts and bruises, and a total wreck
of the car. The big arroyo has a wide mouth. Its
existence needs no explanation. People in the area
regard the arroyo much as they might regard a living
60 being, which has a certain character and personality.
I seldom drive past that wide deep arroyo without
feeling a familiarity with and even a strange affection
for this arroyo. Because as treacherous as it may be,
the arroyo maintains a strong connection between
65 human beings and the earth. The arroyo demands
from us the caution and attention that constitute
respect. It is this sort of respect the old believers have
in mind when they tell us we must respect and love
the earth.

29. The author argues that landscapes and dreams are similar in which of the following ways?
- (A) Both give visible shape to intangible emotions.
 - (B) Both lend themselves to solitary contemplation.
 - (C) Both serve to disturb or alter the status quo.
 - (D) Both have surprising and unforeseen contours.
 - (E) Both reveal the insecurities of the person who experiences them.
30. The words “Even now” (line 12) and “Nearly always” (line 15) serve to
- (A) reveal the contradictory perspectives in Laguna Pueblo legends
 - (B) stress the continuing place of legend in Laguna culture
 - (C) attest to the factual basis of many legendary events
 - (D) concede that legends can play several distinct cultural roles
 - (E) qualify the author's point that legends are relevant to modern human experience

31. Which of the following best describes the effect of the repetition of the word “you” in lines 31-35 ?
- (A) It disassociates the author from Laguna stories and rituals.
 - (B) It emphasizes the consoling effects of Laguna stories for an individual.
 - (C) It stresses the author’s sympathy for the sufferings of the Lagunas.
 - (D) It contrasts with the intimate tone established earlier in the passage.
 - (E) It undermines statements about the commonality of certain experiences.
32. The shift from the second to the third paragraph represents a shift from
- (A) generalization to specific example
 - (B) one universal observation to another
 - (C) assertive to speculative writing
 - (D) a metaphorical flourish to a literal proposition
 - (E) a focused argument to a digression
33. In lines 41-46 (“A few . . . arroyo”), the author cites the loss of the Vietnam veteran’s car primarily to
- (A) point out the dangers of careless driving
 - (B) exemplify the treatment of veterans of the Vietnam War
 - (C) demonstrate that loss of property is unimportant when compared with loss of life
 - (D) provide an example of a story that will be retold
 - (E) warn others who might tempt fate in a similar way
34. The story told in lines 50-57 (“But this . . . the car”) serves to
- (A) retell an ancient Laguna myth in contemporary terms
 - (B) convey the author’s concern about the consequences of the Vietnam War
 - (C) ironically highlight how awful the veteran’s predicament really was
 - (D) illustrate that the veteran’s disaster was not just an individual, isolating experience
 - (E) examine why the arroyo inspires fear and dread
35. The sentence in line 57 (“The big arroyo has a wide mouth”) uses which of the following?
- (A) Paradox
 - (B) Satire
 - (C) Personification
 - (D) Contrast
 - (E) Simile
36. The statement that the arroyo’s “existence needs no explanation” (line 58) resembles most closely the view of
- (A) the “individual” (line 9)
 - (B) “children” (line 20)
 - (C) the Vietnam veteran (line 42)
 - (D) the man whose station wagon rolled into the arroyo (lines 50-57)
 - (E) “the old believers” (line 67)
37. The author feels a “strange affection” (line 62) for the arroyo primarily because it
- (A) is depicted as having human qualities in many Laguna legends
 - (B) symbolizes how resilient the natural landscape can be when it is abused
 - (C) is a place that has been familiar since childhood
 - (D) attracts visitors who are interested in the Laguna area
 - (E) generates stories and legends that connect the local inhabitants to the earth
38. The author’s devices of argument in the passage include which of the following?
- I. Reinforcing a case by including a personal perspective
 - II. Providing a specific example to illustrate an abstract concept
 - III. Citing the evidence of historical scholarship
- (A) I only
 - (B) I and II only
 - (C) I and III only
 - (D) II and III only
 - (E) I, II, and III

The passage is reprinted for your use in answering the remaining questions.

(This passage is from a contemporary essay.)

Line Landscape thus has similarities with dreams. Both
have the power to seize terrifying feelings and deep
instincts and translate them into images—visual,
5 aural, tactile—into the concrete where human beings
may more readily confront and channel the terrifying
instincts or powerful emotions into rituals and narra-
tives which reassure the individual while reaffirming
cherished values of the group. The identity of the
individual as a part of the group and the greater
10 Whole is strengthened, and the terror of facing the
world alone is extinguished.

Even now, the people at Laguna Pueblo spend
the greater portion of social occasions recounting
recent incidents or events which have occurred in
15 the Laguna area. Nearly always, the discussion will
precipitate the retelling of older stories about similar
incidents or other stories connected with a specific
place. The stories often contain disturbing or provoc-
ative material, but are nonetheless told in the presence
20 of children and women. The effect of these inter-
family or inter-clan exchanges is the reassurance for
each person that she or he will never be separated or
apart from the clan, no matter what might happen.
Neither the worst blunders or disasters nor the
25 greatest financial prosperity and joy will ever be
permitted to isolate anyone from the rest of the group.
In the ancient times, cohesiveness was all that stood
between extinction and survival, and, while the indi-
vidual certainly was recognized, it was always as an
30 individual simultaneously bonded to family and clan
by a complex bundle of custom and ritual. You are
never the first to suffer a grave loss or profound
humiliation. You are never the first, and you under-
stand that you will probably not be the last to commit
35 or be victimized by a repugnant act. Your family and
clan are able to go on at length about others now
passed on, others older or more experienced than
you who suffered similar losses.

The wide deep arroyo near the Kings Bar (located
40 across the reservation borderline) has over the years
claimed many vehicles. A few years ago, when a
Vietnam veteran's new red Volkswagen rolled back-
wards into the arroyo while he was inside buying a
six-pack of beer, the story of his loss joined the lively
45 and large collection of stories already connected with
that big arroyo. I do not know whether the Vietnam
veteran was consoled when he was told the stories
about the other cars claimed by the ravenous arroyo.
All his savings of combat pay had gone for the red

50 Volkswagen. But this man could not have felt any
worse than the man who, some years before, had left
his children and mother-in-law in his station wagon
with the engine running. When he came out of the
liquor store his station wagon was gone. He found
55 it and its passengers upside down in the big arroyo.
Broken bones, cuts and bruises, and a total wreck
of the car. The big arroyo has a wide mouth. Its
existence needs no explanation. People in the area
regard the arroyo much as they might regard a living
60 being, which has a certain character and personality.
I seldom drive past that wide deep arroyo without
feeling a familiarity with and even a strange affection
for this arroyo. Because as treacherous as it may be,
the arroyo maintains a strong connection between
65 human beings and the earth. The arroyo demands
from us the caution and attention that constitute
respect. It is this sort of respect the old believers have
in mind when they tell us we must respect and love
the earth.

39. The author values storytelling because a story-teller has the power to
- (A) give listeners the means to prioritize random events
 - (B) remind listeners that most experiences have a happy outcome
 - (C) help listeners to realize that their troubles are not unique
 - (D) permit listeners to enjoy the pleasure of a suspenseful tale
 - (E) answer questions that have previously baffled listeners
40. Taken as a whole, the passage is best described as
- (A) an implicit defense of a controversial idea
 - (B) an expository piece relying chiefly on comparison and contrast
 - (C) an explanatory account including historical and contemporary perspectives
 - (D) a descriptive passage built on a sequence of mythic events
 - (E) a satiric investigation and refutation of outdated beliefs
41. The author would be most likely to describe the legends of the people at Laguna Pueblo as which of the following?
- (A) A body of stories periodically refreshed by the addition of relevant new stories
 - (B) A set of stories requiring frequent revision to reflect linguistic change
 - (C) A series of fragile constructions, vulnerable to being forgotten and lost
 - (D) Direct transcriptions of their storytellers' most vivid dreams
 - (E) Imaginative responses to unprecedented human victories and disappointments

Questions 42-55. Read the following passage carefully before you choose your answers.

(This passage is from the preface to a work published early in the nineteenth century.)

- The prevailing taste of the public for anecdote has been censured and ridiculed by critics, who aspire to the character of superior wisdom: but if we consider it in a proper point of view, this taste is an incontestible proof of the good sense and profoundly philosophic temper of the present times. Of the numbers who study, or at least who read history, how few derive any advantage from their labors! The heroes of history are so decked out by the fine fancy of the professed historian; they talk in such measured prose, and act from such sublime or such diabolical motives, that few have sufficient taste, wickedness or heroism, to sympathize in their fate. Besides, there is much uncertainty even in the best authenticated ancient* or modern histories; and that love of truth, which in some minds is innate and immutable, necessarily leads to a love of secret memoirs and private anecdotes. We cannot judge either of the feelings or of the characters of men with perfect accuracy from their actions or their appearance in public; it is from their careless conversations, their half-finished sentences, that we may hope with the greatest probability of success to discover their real characters. The life of a great or of a little man written by himself, the familiar letters, the diary of any individual published by his friends, or by his enemies after his decease, are esteemed important literary curiosities. We are surely justified in this eager desire to collect the most minute facts relative to the domestic lives, not only of the great and the good, but even of the worthless and insignificant, since it is only by a comparison of their actual happiness or misery in the privacy of domestic life, that we can form a just estimate of the real reward of virtue, or the real punishment of vice. That the great are not as happy as they seem, that the external circumstances of fortune and rank do not constitute felicity, is asserted by every moralist; the historian can seldom, consistently with his dignity, pause to illustrate this truth, it is therefore to the biographer we must have recourse. After we have beheld splendid characters playing their parts on the great theatre of the world, with all the advantages of stage effect and decoration, we anxiously beg to be admitted behind the scenes, that we may take a nearer view of the actors and actresses.
- Some may perhaps imagine, that the value of biography depends upon the judgment and taste of the biographer; but on the contrary it may be maintained, that the merits of a biographer are inversely as

the extent of his intellectual powers and of his literary talents. A plain unvarnished tale is preferable to the most highly ornamented narrative. Where we see that a man has the power, we may naturally suspect that he has the will to deceive us, and those who are used to literary manufacture know how much is often sacrificed to the rounding of a period or the pointing an antithesis.

* ancient

42. In the context of the entire passage, the word “anecdote” (line 1) is best understood to mean
- (A) an unreliable secondhand account
 - (B) an official government document
 - (C) a narrative in the style of a morality play
 - (D) an informal story involving personal details
 - (E) a timeless legend
43. The author portrays the critics mentioned in line 2 as people who are likely to
- (A) identify with the public at large
 - (B) become the subjects of biography
 - (C) be profoundly philosophical
 - (D) keep diaries themselves
 - (E) prefer formal history
44. The author’s strategy in lines 1-8 is to
- (A) flatter those who would criticize popular opinions
 - (B) incite readers to act in a manner inconsistent with their beliefs
 - (C) moralize about the injustices present in society
 - (D) build a logical argument and support it with facts from history
 - (E) promote an impression of sympathy with public preferences

45. In the context of the passage, the reason that few who read history “derive any advantage from their labors” (lines 7-8) is that
- (A) the common reader is unable to appreciate what he or she reads
 - (B) the historian’s preoccupation with facts makes for dull reading
 - (C) the focus of history on the distant past is too remote for most readers
 - (D) the historian tends to present historical figures unrealistically
 - (E) most historical accounts tend to moralize
46. In line 13, “their fate” refers to the fate of
- (A) readers
 - (B) literary critics
 - (C) historical figures
 - (D) fictional characters
 - (E) victims of misfortune
47. The author suggests that the preference of many readers for “secret memoirs and private anecdotes” (lines 16-17) is
- (A) a reprehensible reaction in terms of its consequences
 - (B) a grudging response to heroic lives
 - (C) an unfortunate lapse in propriety
 - (D) a justifiable form of curiosity
 - (E) a natural result of a love of fiction
48. In context, the phrase “half-finished sentences” (line 21) can best be described as
- (A) an allusion to ineffective style
 - (B) a reference to informal candor
 - (C) an apology for incomplete histories
 - (D) a symbol of the arrogance of great people
 - (E) an ironic statement about fastidiousness
49. In the context of the sentence in which it occurs, the phrase “consistently with his dignity” (line 37) points out
- (A) the conflict between decorum and thoroughness for the historian
 - (B) the loss of esteem suffered by the historian
 - (C) the social gulf between historians and biographers
 - (D) the expertise that the historian brings to a work
 - (E) public disdain for undignified narrative
50. The sentence “Some may . . . talents” (lines 45-50) includes all of the following EXCEPT a
- (A) personal anecdote
 - (B) paradoxical statement
 - (C) premise for consideration
 - (D) refutation of an assumption
 - (E) logical extension of ideas expressed in the first paragraph
51. The purpose of the sentence “A plain . . . narrative” (lines 50-51) is to
- (A) propose a self-contradictory opinion for consideration
 - (B) elaborate on a specific anecdote
 - (C) shift the thematic focus considerably
 - (D) develop a statement made in the previous sentence
 - (E) create a stylistic effect through literary allusion

The passage is reprinted for your use in answering the remaining questions.

(This passage is from the preface to a work published early in the nineteenth century.)

Line The prevailing taste of the public for anecdote has
5 been censured and ridiculed by critics, who aspire to
the character of superior wisdom: but if we consider it
in a proper point of view, this taste is an incontestible
proof of the good sense and profoundly philosophic
temper of the present times. Of the numbers who study,
or at least who read history, how few derive any advantage
from their labors! The heroes of history are so
decked out by the fine fancy of the professed historian;
10 they talk in such measured prose, and act from such
sublime or such diabolical motives, that few have sufficient
taste, wickedness or heroism, to sympathize in
their fate. Besides, there is much uncertainty even in
the best authenticated ancient* or modern histories;
15 and that love of truth, which in some minds is innate
and immutable, necessarily leads to a love of secret
memoirs and private anecdotes. We cannot judge either
of the feelings or of the characters of men with perfect
accuracy from their actions or their appearance
20 in public; it is from their careless conversations, their
half-finished sentences, that we may hope with the
greatest probability of success to discover their real
characters. The life of a great or of a little man written
by himself, the familiar letters, the diary of any individual
25 published by his friends, or by his enemies after
his decease, are esteemed important literary curiosities.
We are surely justified in this eager desire to collect the
most minute facts relative to the domestic lives, not
only of the great and the good, but even of the worthless
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of their actual happiness or misery in the privacy of
domestic life, that we can form a just estimate of the
real reward of virtue, or the real punishment of vice.
That the great are not as happy as they seem, that the
35 external circumstances of fortune and rank do not
constitute felicity, is asserted by every moralist; the
historian can seldom, consistently with his dignity,
pause to illustrate this truth, it is therefore to the biographer
we must have recourse. After we have beheld
40 splendid characters playing their parts on the great
theatre of the world, with all the advantages of stage
effect and decoration, we anxiously beg to be admitted
behind the scenes, that we may take a nearer view of
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45 Some may perhaps imagine, that the value of
biography depends upon the judgment and taste of
the biographer; but on the contrary it may be maintained,
that the merits of a biographer are inversely as

the extent of his intellectual powers and of his literary
50 talents. A plain unvarnished tale is preferable to the
most highly ornamented narrative. Where we see that
a man has the power, we may naturally suspect that he
has the will to deceive us, and those who are used to
literary manufacture know how much is often sacrificed
55 to the rounding of a period or the pointing an
antithesis.

* ancient

52. The author uses the phrase “highly ornamented narrative” (line 51) to refer to the type of writing that is
- (A) preferred by most readers
 - (B) produced by biographers skilled at writing
 - (C) found in secret journals
 - (D) presented most realistically
 - (E) rejected by historians
53. In the final sentence (lines 51-56), the author presents “the rounding of a period” and “the pointing an antithesis” as examples of
- (A) techniques ignored by most historians
 - (B) flourishes that can obscure truth
 - (C) inaccuracies that can slip into biographies
 - (D) techniques that appeal to most readers
 - (E) fine points that historical writers should employ

54. Taken as a whole, the passage is best described as

- (A) an indignant response to a personal affront
- (B) a documented presentation of facts
- (C) a casual reaction to a problem
- (D) an extended definition of a term
- (E) an argument employing illustrative comparisons

55. Of the following contrasts, which pertains most directly to the theme of the passage?

- (A) “sublime” (line 11) and “diabolical” (line 11) motives
- (B) “antient” (line 14) and “modern” (line 14) histories
- (C) “their appearance in public” (lines 19-20) and “their real characters” (lines 22-23)
- (D) “great” (line 29) and “insignificant” (line 30) persons
- (E) “virtue” (line 33) and “vice” (line 33)

END OF SECTION I
IF YOU FINISH BEFORE TIME IS CALLED, YOU MAY
CHECK YOUR WORK ON THIS SECTION.

DO NOT GO ON TO SECTION II UNTIL YOU ARE TOLD TO DO SO.

MAKE SURE YOU HAVE DONE THE FOLLOWING.

- **PLACED YOUR AP NUMBER LABEL ON YOUR ANSWER SHEET**
- **WRITTEN AND GRIDDED YOUR AP NUMBER CORRECTLY ON YOUR ANSWER SHEET**
- **TAKEN THE AP EXAM LABEL FROM THE FRONT OF THIS BOOKLET AND PLACED IT ON YOUR ANSWER SHEET**

ENGLISH LANGUAGE AND COMPOSITION

SECTION II

Total time—2 hours

Question 1

(Suggested time—40 minutes. This question counts for one-third of the total essay section score.)

The United States Postal Service (USPS) has delivered communications for more than two centuries. During the nineteenth century, the USPS helped to expand the boundaries of the United States by providing efficient and reliable communication across the country. Between 1790 and 1860 alone, the number of post offices in the United States grew from 75 to over 28,000. With this growth came job opportunities for postal workers and a boom in the cross-country rail system. The twentieth century brought substantial growth to the USPS, including large package delivery and airmail. Over the past decade, however, total mail volume has decreased considerably as competition from electronic mail and various package delivery companies has taken business away from the USPS. The loss of revenue has prompted the USPS to consider cutting back on delivery days and other services.

Carefully read the following seven sources, including the introductory information for each source. Then synthesize information from at least three of the sources and incorporate it into a coherent, well-developed essay that argues a clear position on whether the USPS should be restructured to meet the needs of a changing world, and if so, how.

Make sure your argument is central; use the sources to illustrate and support your reasoning. Avoid merely summarizing the sources. Indicate clearly which sources you are drawing from, whether through direct quotation, paraphrase, or summary. You may cite the sources as Source A, Source B, etc., or by using the descriptions in parentheses.

Source A (Stone)

Source B (graph)

Source C (O’Keefe)

Source D (Hawkins)

Source E (McDevitt)

Source F (Cullen)

Source G (photo)

Source A

Stone, Daniel. "Flying Like an Eagle?" *Newsweek*.
Newsweek, 5 Oct. 2009. Web. 24 Sept. 2010.

The following is excerpted from an online article in a national news magazine.

Anyone who's waited, and waited, in line at the old letter hub knows the service could probably be run better. NEWSWEEK asked a variety of management consultants and business futurists how to turn the old pony express into a sleek, 21st-century moneymaker—or, at the very least, a breaker-even. Listen up, Postal Service (and Congress): for this advice, we'll let you cut in line.

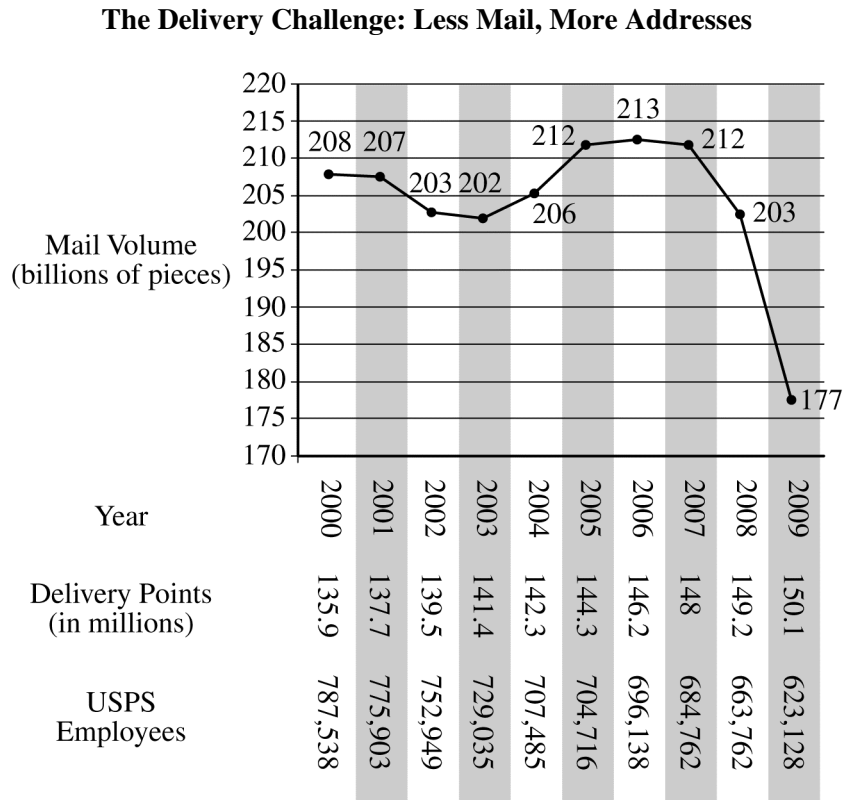
- 1) Get into the e-business. More people are e-mailing? So meet their needs. "Give every American an e-mail address when they're born," suggests futurist Watts Wacker. Might they look elsewhere for a different one? Sure, but at least you'll maintain relevance in their mind. Plus, you can sell lucrative advertising on those accounts.
- 2) Increase service. Don't drop from six- to five-day delivery; go the other way, says Kellogg School marketing prof Richard Honack—to all seven. It seems counterintuitive to add service when you're losing money, but people have less faith in the system precisely because of spotty service. Consider tightening hours, but the USPS could be the first carrier to reliably deliver all week.
- 3) Advertise with coupons. It sounds like an archaic way to attract customers in a new era, but if people are flocking to the Internet, give them an incentive to come back. "We're a coupon-cutting society," says futurist and business strategist Marlene Brown. "Make people feel like there's value added."
- 4) Make a play for control of government broadband [Internet access]. With Congress considering an expansion of broadband access, why not put it under the USPS, asks futurist David Houle. "That would define the Postal Service as a communications-delivery service, rather than just a team of letter carriers. Don't let the service's tie to Congress make it fizzle. If used right, why not use it as an advantage?"
- 5) Rebrand. No one knows what the Postal Service stands for, says Wacker. "Fly like an eagle, what does that even mean?" A company's brand is its most valuable tool, or its biggest liability. Contract out to find a new logo and slogan that actually convey what you do and how you do it. And then use them. (In this week's NEWSWEEK magazine, we asked three design firms to get started.)
- 6) Close branches if you must, but do it strategically. Franchise services by region, posits business strategist Gurumurthy Kalyanaram. You don't need a full-service post office every few blocks in New York, for example. Some centers could be for letters only, others for packages. That way you cut down on staff size and service required to and from each.
- 7) Reorganize and motivate staff. Paying high wages with inflated job security isn't a competitive strategy. Unions may be fierce, but consultant Peter Cohan thinks management should put employee contracts out to bid. And add incentives: if a worker saves money, give him a percentage. Inversely, put jobs on the line to avoid losses. In other words, run it like a real business.

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Source B

“The Challenge to Deliver: Creating the 21st Century Postal Service: United States Postal Service 2009 Annual Report.” *United States Postal Service*. United States Postal Service, 2009. Web. 24 Sept. 2010.

The following graph is excerpted from the 2009 annual report of the United States Postal Service.



Source C

O’Keefe, Ed. “Postal Service Expected to Announce ‘Significant Changes.’” *Washington Post*. Washington Post Company, 2 Mar. 2010. Web. 27 Sept. 2010.

The following is excerpted from an online article in a national newspaper.

The U.S. Postal Service will release projections Tuesday that confirm for the first time the suspicion that mail volume will never return to pre-recession levels. In response, the agency is pushing anew for a dramatic reshaping of how Americans get and send their letters and packages.

Customers are continuing to migrate to the Internet and to cheaper standard-mail options, and away from the Postal Service’s signature product—first-class mail, Postmaster General John E. Potter will report in announcing the projections.

The Postal Service experienced a 13 percent drop in mail volume last fiscal year, more than double any previous decline, and lost \$3.8 billion. The projections anticipate steeper drops in mail volume and revenue over the next 10 years, and mounting labor costs only complicate the agency’s path to firm fiscal footing.

In an effort to offset some of the losses, Potter seeks more flexibility in the coming year to set delivery schedules, prices and labor costs. The changes could mean an end to Saturday deliveries, longer delivery times for letters and packages, higher postage-stamp prices that exceed the rate of inflation, and the potential for future layoffs.

“At the end of the day, I’m convinced that if we make the changes that are necessary, we can continue to provide universal service for Americans for decades to come,” Potter said Monday. “We can turn back from the red to the black, but there are some significant changes we need to make.”

The postmaster general called for many of these changes last year but failed to convince lawmakers. This time he’s armed with \$4.8 million worth of outside studies that conclude that, without drastic changes, the mail agency will face even more staggering losses.

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Source D

Hawkins, Dawn. "Advantages of Using the United States Postal Service." *Associated Content*. Associated Content, 14 Aug. 2009. Web. 27 Sept. 2010.

The following is excerpted from an online article.

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because of copyright constraints.

Source E

McDevitt, Caitlin. "To Postal Workers, No Mail Is 'Junk': With Revenues Falling, the Post Office Owes Its Future to Stuff We Throw Out." *Newsweek*. Newsweek, 27 Sept. 2008. Web. 28 Sept. 2010.

The following is excerpted from an online article in a national news magazine.

These are tough times for the U.S. Postal Service. It's being pummeled by high fuel costs. The soft economy is crimping the overall volume of mail, which fell 5.5 percent in the past year. Its business is also falling as Americans opt for e-mail over birthday cards and thank-you notes. Now comes another threat: consumers like Colleen Plimpton of Bethel, Conn. Earlier this year Plimpton became tired of the credit-card offers, catalogs and advertising fliers that clogged her mailbox. So in February she paid \$20 to GreenDimes, a firm that helps consumers reduce their inflow of "junk mail" by contacting businesses on their behalf. "[Junk mailers] are cutting down trees willy-nilly, and that has got to stop," says Plimpton.

To the post office, consumers like her are a serious threat. "Efforts to convince people not to receive mail are really going to hurt," says Steve Kearney, a Postal Service senior vice president.

The Postal Service lost \$1.1 billion in its latest quarter. That number would be even larger if it weren't for direct mailings, which now constitute 52 percent of mail volume, up from 38 percent in 1990. Revenue from direct mail "is the financial underpinning of the Postal Service—it could not survive without it," says Michael Coughlin, former deputy postmaster.

But 89 percent of consumers say in polls that they'd prefer not to receive direct-marketing mail; 44 percent of it is never opened. That's why 19 state legislatures have debated Do Not Mail lists, which would function just like the federal Do Not Call list. But partly due to opposition from postal workers, not a single bill has passed. When Colorado state Rep. Sara Gagliardi held a public meeting on a bill she was sponsoring, she was surprised when a crowd of postal workers showed up to express vehement opposition.

Both the Postal Service and the Direct Marketing Association say direct mail is a key source of customers for small businesses. "Advertising mail is a very valuable product to many consumers," says Sam Pulcrano, Postal Service vice president for sustainability, who points to two-for-one pizza coupons as especially welcome surprises. To blunt opposition, the DMA recently launched the Mail Moves America coalition to lobby against the restrictions.

GreenDimes founder Pankaj Shah isn't sympathetic. Not only is his company providing a service to consumers, he says, but it has also used its fees to plant more than 1 million trees. "We're all about giving consumers choice, not about bringing down the post office," he says. Still, as more consumers opt out of junk mail, rain, sleet and gloom of night may seem like the least of mail carriers' problems.

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Source F

Cullen, Kevin. "Sending, Getting 'Real' Mail Still Magic." *Commercial-News*. Commercial-News, 20 Mar. 2010. Web. 28 Sept. 2010.

The following is excerpted from an online article.

E-mail is fast and simple, but to me an old-fashioned, handwritten letter has value in this speed-obsessed world. I have deleted hundreds of e-mails in one fell swoop, without taking the time to reread them, but I still have a letter that my Grandpa Cullen sent to me when I was 8.

I like to receive letters, thank-you notes, birthday cards and Christmas cards, and I like to send them too. Even today, it costs just 44 cents to send one from Danville to Sandybeach, Hawaii, or Frozentoos, Alaska . . . a genuine bargain.

Historians worry about the disappearance of permanent, written records. If there were no "real" letters, diaries, governmental files, handbills, pamphlets, magazines, newspapers and books—real ink on real paper—what would be left? Will electronic records even survive for 100 years? And what will happen if they don't? . . .

The Postal Service has been required to pay its own costs since 1970, and it made a profit until 2006. Since then, declining mail volume has created major problems. It delivered 17 percent fewer pieces in 2009 than it did in 2006, and lost \$1.4 billion. That money was borrowed from the U.S. Treasury.

More declines in volume, coupled with the soaring cost of retiree health benefits, could create \$238 billion in losses over the next 10 years, Postmaster General John Potter recently said. Approximately half of the present 300,000 postal workers are expected to retire by 2020.

Eliminating Saturday mail delivery would save \$40 billion over a decade. Potter also wants to close and consolidate 154 post offices. More and more part-time workers would be hired as full-time workers retire.

Clearly, mail delivery isn't going away entirely. It's an essential government function, like feeding the Army. No private contractor will carry a letter from the Florida Keys to Alaska for 44 cents.

I'm going to do my bit by sending more letters.

Our Christmas card list will be expanded. Birthday cards will go to more friends and family. And I'm going to thank more people, in writing, for more things. I will send more cards and letters to offer encouragement, interest and sympathy. It shows good breeding.

I have shoeboxes filled with kind letters sent to me through the years by readers who liked something that I wrote. I always thanked them by return mail. Many friendships began that way. Those messages weren't deleted 100 at a time; they were saved, and they can be reread. . . .

It's satisfying to write a "real" letter, put it in an envelope and drop it into the mailbox. A day or two later, I know, someone will hold it and connect with me. Who knows? It may be read by someone I will never meet, 100 years from now.

Not a bad investment, for 44 cents.

"Sending, Getting 'Real' Mail Still Magic," by Kevin Cullen, copyright © 2010 by Commercial News. Used by permission.

Source G

*Ochopee Post Office, Florida, 1970s. N.d. Photograph.
Collection of the United States Postal Service.
USPS.com. Web. 9 May 2011.*

The following photo, from the Web site of the United States Postal Service, shows the Ochopee Post Office, the smallest free-standing post office in the United States.



Ochopee Post Office, Florida, 1970s © 1970 United States Postal Service. All Rights Reserved. Used with Permission.

Question 2

(Suggested time—40 minutes. This question counts for one-third of the total essay section score.)

On April 10, 1962, as the United States was emerging from a recession, the nation’s largest steel companies raised steel prices by 3.5 percent. President John F. Kennedy, who had repeatedly called for stable prices and wages as part of a program of national sacrifice during a period of economic distress, held a news conference on April 11, 1962, which he opened with the following commentary regarding the hike in steel prices. Read Kennedy’s remarks carefully. Then write an essay in which you analyze the rhetorical strategies President Kennedy uses to achieve his purpose. Support your analysis with specific references to the text.

Simultaneous and identical actions of United States Steel and other leading steel corporations, increasing steel prices by some 6 dollars a ton, constitute a wholly unjustifiable and irresponsible defiance of the public interest.

In this serious hour in our nation’s history, when we are confronted with grave crises in Berlin and Southeast Asia, when we are devoting our energies to economic recovery and stability, when we are asking Reservists to leave their homes and families for months on end, and servicemen to risk their lives—and four were killed in the last two days in Viet Nam—and asking union members to hold down their wage requests, at a time when restraint and sacrifice are being asked of every citizen, the American people will find it hard, as I do, to accept a situation in which a tiny handful of steel executives whose pursuit of private power and profit exceeds their sense of public responsibility can show such utter contempt for the interests of 185 million Americans.

If this rise in the cost of steel is imitated by the rest of the industry, instead of rescinded, it would increase the cost of homes, autos, appliances, and most other items for every American family. It would increase the cost of machinery and tools to every American businessman and farmer. It would seriously handicap our efforts to prevent an inflationary spiral from eating up the pensions of our older citizens, and our new gains in purchasing power.

It would add, Secretary McNamara* informed me this morning, an estimated one billion dollars to the cost of our defenses, at a time when every dollar is needed for national security and other purposes. It would make it more difficult for American goods to compete in foreign markets, more difficult to withstand competition from foreign imports, and thus more difficult to improve our balance of payments position, and stem the flow of gold. And it is necessary to stem it for our national security, if we are going to pay for our security commitments abroad. And it would surely handicap

our efforts to induce other industries and unions to adopt responsible price and wage policies.

The facts of the matter are that there is no justification for an increase in the steel prices. The recent settlement between the industry and the union, which does not even take place until July 1st, was widely acknowledged to be non-inflationary, and the whole purpose and effect of this Administration’s role, which both parties understood, was to achieve an agreement which would make unnecessary any increase in prices.

Steel output per man is rising so fast that labor costs per ton of steel can actually be expected to decline in the next twelve months. And in fact, the Acting Commissioner of the Bureau of Labor Statistics informed me this morning that, and I quote: “Employment costs per unit of steel output in 1961 were essentially the same as they were in 1958.”

The cost of the major raw materials, steel scrap and coal, has also been declining, and for an industry which has been generally operating at less than two-thirds of capacity, its profit rate has been normal and can be expected to rise sharply this year in view of the reduction in idle capacity. Their lot has been easier than that of a hundred thousand steel workers thrown out of work in the last three years. The industry’s cash dividends have exceeded 600 million dollars in each of the last five years, and earnings in the first quarter of this year were estimated in the February 28th Wall Street Journal to be among the highest in history.

In short, at a time when they could be exploring how more efficiency and better prices could be obtained, reducing prices in this industry in recognition of lower costs, their unusually good labor contract, their foreign competition and their increase in production and profits which are coming this year, a few gigantic corporations have decided to increase prices in ruthless disregard of their public responsibilities.

The Steel Workers Union can be proud that it abided by its responsibilities in this agreement, and this government also has responsibilities, which we

intend to meet.

90 The Department of Justice and the Federal Trade Commission are examining the significance of this action in a free, competitive economy.

95 The Department of Defense and other agencies are reviewing its impact on their policies of procurement, and I am informed that steps are underway by those Members of the Congress who plan appropriate inquiries into how these price decisions are so quickly made, and reached, and what legislative safeguards may be needed to protect the public interest.

Price and wage decisions in this country,

100 except for very limited restrictions in the case of monopolies and national emergency strikes, are and ought to be freely and privately made, but the American people have a right to expect in return for that freedom, a higher sense of business
105 responsibility for the welfare of their country than has been shown in the last two days.

Some time ago I asked each American to consider what he would do for his country and I asked the steel companies. In the last 24 hours we had their
110 answer.

* Robert S. McNamara, secretary of defense from 1961 to 1968

Question 3

(Suggested time—40 minutes. This question counts for one-third of the total essay section score.)

Consider the distinct perspectives expressed in the following statements.

If you develop the absolute sense of certainty that powerful beliefs provide, then you can get yourself to accomplish virtually anything, including those things that other people are certain are impossible.

William Lyon Phelps, American educator, journalist, and professor (1865–1943)

I think we ought always to entertain our opinions with some measure of doubt. I shouldn't wish people dogmatically to believe any philosophy, not even mine.

Bertrand Russell, British author, mathematician, and philosopher (1872–1970)

In a well-organized essay, take a position on the relationship between certainty and doubt. Support your argument with appropriate evidence and examples.

STOP

END OF EXAM

THE FOLLOWING INSTRUCTIONS APPLY TO THE COVERS OF THE SECTION II BOOKLET.

- **MAKE SURE YOU HAVE COMPLETED THE IDENTIFICATION INFORMATION AS REQUESTED ON THE FRONT AND BACK COVERS OF THE SECTION II BOOKLET.**
- **CHECK TO SEE THAT YOUR AP NUMBER LABEL APPEARS IN THE BOX(ES) ON THE COVER(S).**
- **MAKE SURE YOU HAVE USED THE SAME SET OF AP NUMBER LABELS ON ALL AP EXAMS YOU HAVE TAKEN THIS YEAR.**

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Write in the box the number of the question you are answering on this page as it is designated in the exam.

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**Answer Key for AP English Language and Composition
Practice Exam, Section I**

Multiple-Choice Questions	
Question #	Key
1	D
2	C
3	D
4	A
5	B
6	D
7	C
8	D
9	E
10	C
11	A
12	E
13	B
14	A
15	B
16	D
17	D
18	B
19	A
20	E
21	A
22	A
23	C
24	B
25	C
26	A
27	A

28	D
29	A
30	B
31	B
32	A
33	D
34	D
35	C
36	E
37	E
38	B
39	C
40	C
41	A
42	D
43	E
44	E
45	D
46	C
47	D
48	B
49	A
50	A
51	D
52	B
53	B
54	E
55	C

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2012 SCORING GUIDELINES

Question 1

The score should reflect a judgment of the essay's quality as a whole. Remember that students had only 15 minutes to read the sources and 40 minutes to write; the essay, therefore, is not a finished product and should not be judged by standards appropriate for an out-of-class assignment. Evaluate the essay as a draft, making certain to reward students for what they do well.

All essays, even those scored 8 or 9, may contain occasional lapses in analysis, prose style, or mechanics. Such features should enter into the holistic evaluation of an essay's overall quality. In no case may an essay with many distracting errors in grammar and mechanics be scored higher than a 2.

- 9** Essays earning a score of 9 meet the criteria for a score of 8 and, in addition, are especially sophisticated in their argument, thorough in development, or impressive in their control of language.

8 Effective

Essays earning a score of 8 **effectively** develop a position on whether the USPS should be restructured to meet the needs of a changing world, and if so, how. They develop their position by effectively synthesizing* at least three of the sources. The evidence and explanations used are appropriate and convincing. Their prose demonstrates a consistent ability to control a wide range of the elements of effective writing but is not necessarily flawless.

- 7** Essays earning a score of 7 meet the criteria for a score of 6 but provide more complete explanation, more thorough development, or a more mature prose style.

6 Adequate

Essays earning a score of 6 **adequately** develop a position on whether the USPS should be restructured to meet the needs of a changing world, and if so, how. They develop their position by adequately synthesizing at least three of the sources. The evidence and explanations used are appropriate and sufficient. The language may contain lapses in diction or syntax, but generally the prose is clear.

- 5** Essays earning a score of 5 develop a position on whether the USPS should be restructured to meet the needs of a changing world, and if so, how. They develop their position by synthesizing at least three sources, but how they use and explain sources is somewhat uneven, inconsistent, or limited. The argument is generally clear, and the sources generally develop the student's position, but the links between the sources and the argument may be strained. The writing may contain lapses in diction or syntax, but it usually conveys the student's ideas.

* For the purposes of scoring, *synthesis* means using sources to develop a position and citing them accurately.

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2012 SCORING GUIDELINES

Question 1 (continued)

4 Inadequate

Essays earning a score of 4 **inadequately** develop a position on whether the USPS should be restructured to meet the needs of a changing world, and if so, how. They develop their position by synthesizing at least two sources, but the evidence or explanations used may be inappropriate, insufficient, or less convincing. The sources may dominate the student's attempts at development; the link between the argument and the sources may be weak; or the student may misunderstand, misrepresent, or oversimplify the sources. The prose generally conveys the student's ideas but may be less consistent in controlling the elements of effective writing.

- 3** Essays earning a score of 3 meet the criteria for a score of 4 but demonstrate less success in developing a position on whether the USPS should be restructured to meet the needs of a changing world, and if so, how. They are less perceptive in their understanding of the sources, or their explanation or examples may be particularly limited or simplistic. The essays may show less maturity in control of writing.

2 Little Success

Essays earning a score of 2 demonstrate **little success** in developing a position on whether the USPS should be restructured to meet the needs of a changing world, and if so, how. They may merely allude to knowledge gained from reading the sources rather than citing the sources themselves. These essays may misread the sources, fail to develop a position, or substitute a simpler task by merely summarizing or categorizing the sources or by merely responding to the prompt tangentially with unrelated, inaccurate, or inappropriate explanation. The prose of these essays often demonstrates consistent weaknesses in writing, such as grammatical problems, a lack of development or organization, or a lack of control.

- 1** Essays earning a score of 1 meet the criteria for a score of 2 but are undeveloped, especially simplistic in their explanation, weak in their control of writing, or do not allude to or cite even one source.
- 0** Indicates an off-topic response, one that merely repeats the prompt, an entirely crossed-out response, a drawing, or a response in a language other than English.

— Indicates an entirely blank response.

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2012 SCORING GUIDELINES

Question 2

The score should reflect a judgment of the essay's quality as a whole. Remember that students had only 40 minutes to read and write; the essay, therefore, is not a finished product and should not be judged by standards appropriate for an out-of-class assignment. Evaluate the essay as a draft, making certain to reward students for what they do well.

All essays, even those scored 8 or 9, may contain occasional lapses in analysis, prose style, or mechanics. Such features should enter into the holistic evaluation of an essay's overall quality. In no case may an essay with many distracting errors in grammar and mechanics be scored higher than a 2.

- 9** Essays earning a score of 9 meet the criteria for a score of 8 and, in addition, are especially sophisticated in their argument, thorough in their development, or impressive in their control of language.

8 Effective

Essays earning a score of 8 **effectively** analyze* the rhetorical strategies President Kennedy uses to achieve his purpose. They develop their analysis with evidence and explanations that are appropriate and convincing, referring to the passage explicitly or implicitly. The prose demonstrates a consistent ability to control a wide range of the elements of effective writing but is not necessarily flawless.

- 7** Essays earning a score of 7 meet the criteria for a score of 6 but provide more complete explanation, more thorough development, or a more mature prose style.

6 Adequate

Essays earning a score of 6 **adequately** analyze the rhetorical strategies President Kennedy uses to achieve his purpose. They develop their analysis with evidence and explanations that are appropriate and sufficient, referring to the passage explicitly or implicitly. The writing may contain lapses in diction or syntax, but generally the prose is clear.

- 5** Essays earning a score of 5 analyze the rhetorical strategies President Kennedy uses to achieve his purpose. The evidence or explanations used may be uneven, inconsistent, or limited. The writing may contain lapses in diction or syntax, but it usually conveys the student's ideas.

4 Inadequate

Essays earning a score of 4 **inadequately** analyze the rhetorical strategies President Kennedy uses to achieve his purpose. These essays may misunderstand the passage, misrepresent the strategies Kennedy uses, or may analyze these strategies insufficiently. The evidence or explanations used may be inappropriate, insufficient, or less convincing. The prose generally conveys the student's ideas but may be less consistent in controlling the elements of effective writing.

* For the purposes of scoring, *analysis* refers to identifying features of a text and explaining how the author uses these to develop meaning or to achieve a particular effect or purpose.

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2012 SCORING GUIDELINES

Question 2 (continued)

- 3** Essays earning a score of 3 meet the criteria for a score of 4 but demonstrate less success in analyzing the rhetorical strategies President Kennedy uses to achieve his purpose. They are less perceptive in their understanding of the passage or Kennedy's strategies, or the explanations or examples may be particularly limited or simplistic. The essays may show less maturity in control of writing.

2 Little Success

Essays earning a score of 2 demonstrate **little success** in analyzing the rhetorical strategies President Kennedy uses to achieve his purpose. These essays may misunderstand the prompt, misread the passage, fail to analyze the strategies Kennedy uses, or substitute a simpler task by responding to the prompt tangentially with unrelated, inaccurate, or inappropriate explanation. The prose often demonstrates consistent weaknesses in writing, such as grammatical problems, a lack of development or organization, or a lack of control.

- 1** Essays earning a score of 1 meet the criteria for a score of 2 but are undeveloped, especially simplistic in their explanation, or weak in their control of language.
- 0** Indicates an off-topic response, one that merely repeats the prompt, an entirely crossed-out response, a drawing, or a response in a language other than English.
- Indicates an entirely blank response.

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2012 SCORING GUIDELINES

Question 3

The score should reflect a judgment of the essay's quality as a whole. Remember that students had only 40 minutes to read and write; the essay, therefore, is not a finished product and should not be judged by standards appropriate for an out-of-class assignment. Evaluate the essay as a draft, making certain to reward students for what they do well.

All essays, even those scored 8 or 9, may contain occasional lapses in analysis, prose style, or mechanics. Such features should enter into the holistic evaluation of an essay's overall quality. In no case may an essay with many distracting errors in grammar and mechanics be scored higher than a 2.

- 9 Essays earning a score of 9 meet the criteria for a score of 8 and, in addition, are especially sophisticated in their argument, thorough in their development, or particularly impressive in their control of language.

8 Effective

Essays earning a score of 8 **effectively** develop a position on the relationship between certainty and doubt. The evidence and explanations used are appropriate and convincing, and the argument is especially coherent and well developed. The prose demonstrates a consistent ability to control a wide range of the elements of effective writing but is not necessarily flawless.

- 7 Essays earning a score of 7 meet the criteria for a score of 6 but provide a more complete explanation, more thorough development, or a more mature prose style.

6 Adequate

Essays earning a score of 6 **adequately** develop a position on the relationship between certainty and doubt. The evidence and explanations used are appropriate and sufficient, and the argument is coherent and adequately developed. The writing may contain lapses in diction or syntax, but generally the prose is clear.

- 5 Essays earning a score of 5 develop a position on the relationship between certainty and doubt. The evidence or explanations used may be uneven, inconsistent, or limited. The writing may contain lapses in diction or syntax, but it usually conveys the student's ideas.

4 Inadequate

Essays earning a score of 4 **inadequately** develop a position on the relationship between certainty and doubt. The evidence or explanations used may be inappropriate, insufficient, or less convincing. The argument may have lapses in coherence or be inadequately developed. The prose generally conveys the student's ideas but may be less consistent in controlling the elements of effective writing.

- 3 Essays earning a score of 3 meet the criteria for a score of 4 but demonstrate less success in developing a position on the relationship between certainty and doubt. The essays may show less maturity in control of writing.

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2012 SCORING GUIDELINES

Question 3 (continued)

2 Little Success

Essays earning a score of 2 demonstrate **little success** in developing a position on the relationship between certainty and doubt. These essays may misunderstand the prompt or substitute a simpler task by responding to the prompt tangentially with unrelated, inaccurate, or inappropriate explanation. The prose often demonstrates consistent weaknesses in writing, such as grammatical problems, a lack of development or organization, or a lack of coherence and control.

- 1** Essays earning a score of 1 meet the criteria for a score of 2 but are undeveloped, especially simplistic in their explanation and argument, weak in their control of language, or especially lacking in coherence and development.
- 0** Indicates an off-topic response, one that merely repeats the prompt, an entirely crossed-out response, a drawing, or a response in a language other than English.
- Indicates an entirely blank response.